Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-05

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 2:1-8

1 Thus says the Lord: "For three transgressions of Moab, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because he burned the bones of the king of Edom to lime.

2 But I will send a fire upon Moab, and it shall devour the palaces of Kerioth; Moab shall die with tumult, with shouting and trumpet sound.

3 And I will cut off the judge from its midst, and slay all its princes with him," says the Lord.

4 Thus says the Lord: "For three transgressions of Judah, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they have despised the law of the Lord, and have not kept His commandments. Their lies lead them astray, lies which their fathers followed.

5 But I will send a fire upon Judah, and it shall devour the palaces of Jerusalem."

6 Thus says the Lord: "For three transgressions of Israel, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they sell the righteous for silver, and the poor for a pair of sandals.

7 They pant after the dust of the earth which is on the head of the poor, and pervert the way of the humble. A man and his father go in to the same girl, to defile My holy name.

8 They lie down by every altar on clothes taken in pledge, and drink the wine of the condemned in the house of their god."

II. Key Summary

• Moab has committed three transgressions, and four, because he burned the bones of the king of Edom to lime; the Lord will send a fire upon Moab, devour the palaces of Kerioth, and cut off its judge and all its princes (vv. 1–3).

• Judah has committed three transgressions, and four, because they despised the law of the Lord, did not keep His commandments, and were led astray by the lies their fathers followed; the Lord will send a fire upon Judah and devour the palaces of Jerusalem (vv. 4–5).

• Israel has committed three transgressions, and four, and the Lord will not turn away its punishment: they sell the righteous for silver and the poor for a pair of sandals, pervert the way of the humble, lie down by every altar on clothes taken in pledge, and drink the wine of the condemned in the house of their god (vv. 6–8).

III. Passage Analysis

The Price of a Pair of Sandals

> Creditors sold debtors as slaves to recover their debts, even for a debt as small as the price of a pair of sandals. [1]

Verse 6 puts "the righteous" next to "silver," and "the poor" next to "a pair of sandals," in the same sentence.

The price of a poor person was one pair of sandals.

Clothes and Wine Brought into the Temple

> Amos, with wonderful irony, marks the ghastly mixture of sin and worship, "they drank the wine of the amerced" - where? "in the house of their God," ⋯ What hard-heartedness to the willfully-forgotten poor is compensated by a little Church-going! [2]

Verse 8 names two places: "by every altar" and "in the house of their god." What they lie on is "clothes taken in pledge," and what they drink is "the wine of the condemned."

What they took from other people, they carried right into the place of worship.

IV. Reflection Question

If selling out a classmate who is weaker than you could get you a small reward, as small as a pair of sandals, what would you do?

Israel faced that same trade: they "sell the righteous for silver, and the poor for a pair of sandals," and the Lord said, "I will not turn away its punishment." (v. 6)

References

[1] 華人基督徒查經資料網站 (Chinese Christian Bible Study), Amos 2 notes (Chain-Reference Bible Notes, Amos 2:6), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT02.htm

[2] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible (Amos 2:8), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/2-8.htm